■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, September 07, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Scientists find a way to slash computer memory energy use by orders of magnitude*

The Angle: *Every phone, laptop and data center on the planet burns energy just holding memory in place — a breakthrough here means cooler devices, longer battery life, and less power-hungry AI infrastructure.*

- Researchers say the method could cut computer **memory energy use** by **orders of magnitude**
- The savings target one of the most power-hungry parts of modern computing: **data storage/retrieval**
- Comes as **AI data centers** are straining power grids across North America

The Debate Starter

- If this actually scales, would you care more that your phone battery lasts days, or that AI data centers stop guzzling your local power grid?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2026/09/260906170132.htm

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■ *FBI investigating 153 million US and Canadian driver's licenses leaked on Russian cybercrime forum, including that of US SecDef Pete Hegseth — data is suspected to have come from an ID-authentication service provider*

The Angle: *This isn't some random data dump — it's basically every driver in the US and Canada rolled into one leak, and somehow it includes the sitting Secretary of Defense. That's the kind of story that makes everyone check if their own license number is floating around Russian cybercrime forums.*

- **153 million** US and Canadian driver's licenses reportedly leaked onto a Russian cybercrime forum
- The **FBI** is now investigating the breach
- Leaked data reportedly includes that of US **Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth**
- Source is suspected to be a third-party **ID-authentication service provider**, not the government directly

The Debate Starter

- If the Defense Secretary's ID isn't safe, what makes you think yours is?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/cyber-security/fbi-investigating-153-million-us-and-canadian-drivers-licenses-leaked-on-russian-cybercrime-forum-including-that-of-us-secdef-pete-hegseth-data-is-suspected-to-have-come-from-an-id-authentication-service-provider

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■ *Trump Says Canada's Dollar 'Imbalance' With US Is Unacceptable*

The Angle: *Trump is once again picking a fight over trade with Canada, this time zeroing in on the currency gap between the loonie and the greenback - a comment that could be the opening shot in a new round of tariff talk between the two countries.*

- **Donald Trump** called the dollar 'imbalance' between the **US and Canada** unacceptable
- The remark lands amid ongoing friction over **US-Canada trade** relations

The Debate Starter

- Is this just Trump venting, or the first sign of new tariff threats aimed at Canada?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-06/trump-says-canada-s-dollar-imbalance-with-us-is-unacceptable

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■■ *"Get up, Governor": Donald Trump attacks Mark Carney again*

The Angle: *Trump taking fresh shots at Canada's Prime Minister is the latest round in an ongoing cross-border feud that keeps spilling into US-Canada relations - and it's got Canadians talking today.*

- Trump's latest jab: **"Get up, Governor"** — aimed directly at Canadian PM **Mark Carney**
- It's part of a recurring pattern of Trump publicly needling Carney
- Story is lighting up **r/canada** as Canadians react to the dig

The Debate Starter

- Does Trump needling Carney actually land, or has the 'Governor' bit officially worn out its welcome?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.journaldemontreal.com/2026/09/06/get-up-governor---trump-sattaque-de-nouveau-a-carney

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■ *Far-right victory in German state expected to send shockwaves throughout the world*

The Angle: *A far-right party winning power in a German state isn't just a local election story — it's the kind of shift that rattles allies, markets, and the whole conversation about where Europe's headed next.*

The Debate Starter

- Does a state-level vote in Germany actually change anything for us over here, or is this just scary headlines?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/far-right-afd-germany-world-reaction-9.7334688?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *Reporting on 9/11: The day the world changed*

The Angle: *With the 25th anniversary of 9/11 coming up, CBC correspondents who were in the newsroom that morning are opening up about the chaos of covering the biggest story of their careers in real time — a gut-check moment for anyone who remembers exactly where they were.*

- Correspondents **Adrienne Arsenault**, **Ioanna Roumeliotis**, **Paul Hunter** and **David Common** are reflecting on covering 9/11 as it happened.
- They describe it as starting like **any other workday** in the CBC newsroom — until it wasn't.
- The reflections mark **25 years** since the attacks reshaped how newsrooms cover breaking news.

The Watercooler Question

- Ask listeners: where were you and what do you remember most clearly from that morning?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7333608?cmp=rss

■ *Multiple people stabbed in Crown Heights as notoriously violent West Indian American Day parade kicks off*

The Angle: *The West Indian American Day Parade is one of the biggest cultural celebrations in the country, but it's dogged by a violent reputation every single year — and right on cue, three people got stabbed in Crown Heights before it even started.*

- **Three men** were stabbed in **Crown Heights, Brooklyn** early **Monday morning**, according to police
- The stabbings happened just **hours before** the **West Indian American Day parade** was set to kick off
- Police describe the parade as **"notoriously violent"** — this isn't the first time violence has overshadowed the event

The Debate Starter

- Every year the parade's culture gets buried under violence headlines — is that a security failure, a media narrative, or both?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/07/us-news/multiple-people-stabbed-in-crown-heights-as-notoriously-violent-west-indian-american-day-parade-kicks-off/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■■ *'The single largest obstacle': Expert questions whether Canada can trust another U.S. trade deal*

The Angle: *An expert is saying the quiet part out loud: after years of tariff whiplash and broken promises, trust might be the one thing no new U.S.-Canada trade deal can paper over.*

The Debate Starter

- If Washington came back with a 'better deal' tomorrow, would you actually believe them - or is trust already gone?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://ca.news.yahoo.com/the-single-largest-obstacle-expert-questions-whether-canada-can-trust-another-us-trade-deal-110000436.html

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■■ *Supercharged El Niño heading for record strength; Canada’s winter may ‘take a holiday,’ climatologist says*

The Angle: *A climatologist is warning that a record-strength El Niño could mean Canada's winter basically skips town this year — huge deal for anyone planning ski trips, dreading heating bills, or just bracing for the cold.*

- A **climatologist** is warning this could be a **record-strength El Niño** winter
- The headline claim: Canada's winter may **'take a holiday'** this year

The Debate Starter

- Would you be thrilled or genuinely disappointed if winter barely showed up this year?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/climate-and-environment/article/less-snow-more-rain-fewer-hurricanes-what-a-record-breaking-el-nino-could-mean-for-canada/

🛩■ *Stephen Fuhr was mocked for opposing the purchase of F-35s. Now he's in charge of Canada's defence procurement*

The Angle: *A former fighter pilot who publicly ripped Canada's F-35 deal is now the guy deciding how Ottawa spends its ballooning defence budget - that's the kind of political irony that writes itself.*

- **Stephen Fuhr** is a former fighter pilot who was mocked for opposing the F-35 purchase
- He's now overseeing Canada's **defence procurement**
- He could be steering a **dramatic increase** in the defence budget
- He's been a long-time critic of buying **U.S. jets** specifically

The Debate Starter

- Is this a case of 'told you so' vindication, or a conflict of interest waiting to happen?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/stephen-fuhr-canada-defence-procurement-rcaf-f35-9.7333073

Backup options:

■ *It's back to school season. Here's why there's a push to get rid of cars at dropoff and pickup*

The Angle: *It's the first week back to school, which means gridlock chaos at every dropoff zone in the country — and a Canadian non-profit thinks the fix is just... no cars at all.*

- **Green Communities Canada**, a national environmental non-profit, is pushing pilot projects to clear cars out of school dropoff and pickup zones.
- The push is timed to the **back-to-school season** as parents return to the daily carpool-line scramble.
- The idea centers on **car-free zones** right outside schools, not a full ban on driving kids to school.

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually park a block away and walk your kid in, or is the pickup line chaos just the price of convenience?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/climate/school-streets-canada-9.7320074?cmp=rss

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■ *Why more than 150 years later, Hamilton's Nine Hour Movement still matters*

The Angle: *It's a Canadian labour story with a twist: the workers technically lost, but their march is the reason we don't work 12-hour shifts today, and it's landing right as the 4-day workweek debate is back in the news.*

- On **May 15, 1872**, roughly **1,500 workers** marched through **Hamilton, Ontario** demanding a shorter workday.
- Their ask: cut the workday down to **nine hours**.
- The movement itself **ultimately failed** in the short term.
- Historians credit it with paving the way for the **worker protection laws** we have today, **150+ years later**.

The Debate Starter

- If workers marched in the streets for a 9-hour day in 1872, what would it take to get people marching for a 4-day week now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/hamilton/nine-hour-movement-hamilton-9.7333061?cmp=rss

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■ *Dutch elm disease ravaged Canadian cities. Can we help trees protect themselves?*

The Angle: *Dutch elm disease wiped out the leafy canopies that used to line streets in cities across Canada and the U.S., and now researchers are deliberately giving healthy elms the disease to find the rare ones that fight it off.*

- Scientists in **Vermont** spent the whole summer infecting **thousands of elm trees** with **Dutch elm disease** on purpose.
- The goal: find a new generation of elms with natural **resistance** to the fungus.
- Dutch elm disease has been **decimating elm populations** across the **U.S. and Canada** for **decades**.
- Many Canadian cities lost their iconic elm-lined streets to this exact plague.

The Nostalgia Hook

- Ask listeners: did your street used to be lined with elm trees before this disease wiped them out?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/science/dutch-elm-disease-9.7329751?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Nathan Fielder and Lance Oppenheim’s Elizabeth Holmes Doc Revealed as Telluride’s Surprise Secret Screening*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A surprise Telluride secret-screening documentary from Nathan Fielder and Lance Oppenheim about Elizabeth Holmes combines two buzzy auteurs with the public's still-active Theranos fascination.

The Angle: *Telluride's mystery screening slot is always a bomb, and this year it detonated with a documentary about the Theranos fraud queen, made by the guy behind 'The Rehearsal' - that combo alone guarantees this one's getting talked about.*

- **Nathan Fielder** (**"The Rehearsal," "Nathan For You"**) and **Lance Oppenheim** are the filmmakers behind the project.
- The subject is **Elizabeth Holmes**, the disgraced **Theranos** founder currently serving federal prison time for fraud.
- It was unveiled as the **Telluride Film Festival's** secret/surprise screening - a slot notoriously used to unveil awards-season bombshells.

The Debate Starter

- Nathan Fielder's whole thing is cringe-comedy realism - can that style actually do justice to a story this dark, or does it risk turning a fraud that hurt real patients into a joke?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/elizabeth-holmes-documentary-trailer-teaser-watch-1236692828/

■■ *Ziwe preview of upcoming guests: Hasan Piker, Kathy Griffin, Vic Mensa, Wanda Sykes, and a guest who walks out of the interview*

The Angle: *Ziwe's confrontational interview style already makes stars squirm - this season she's got a stacked guest list and, apparently, someone who couldn't take the heat and walked.*

- Confirmed upcoming guests include **Hasan Piker**, **Kathy Griffin**, **Vic Mensa**, and **Wanda Sykes**
- One unnamed guest reportedly **walks out** in the middle of their interview
- Ziwe is known for uncomfortable, pointed questions that put celebrities on the spot

The Guessing Game

- Callers: place your bets - which of these four do you think is the one who walks out?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/oww1gufinynh1

■ *Rob Reiner posthumous Emmys 2026 win for 'The Bear' makes history — and has special family connection*

The Angle: *A posthumous Emmy win is always a gut-punch moment, and this one's got extra weight because it's Rob Reiner, a guy who basically helped invent the modern sitcom, going out on top for a scene-stealing guest role on one of TV's hottest shows.*

- **Rob Reiner** passed away in **December 2025**
- He was nominated back in **July** for **Best Guest Actor in a Comedy**
- The role: playing **Albert** on FX's **"The Bear"**
- The win makes Emmy history as a posthumous honor

The Tribute Angle

- Which posthumous award moment actually made you tear up — this one, or someone else's?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/09/07/entertainment/rob-reiner-posthumous-emmys-2026-win-for-the-bear-makes-history-has-family-connection/

■■ *Mom Saves Shocking Amount of Money Thrifting Daughter's Dorm Room Decor (Exclusive) - People.com*

The Angle: *Back-to-school move-in season hits every family's wallet at once, and this taps straight into the thrifting/budget-hack trend parents are obsessed with right now.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Call in: what's the best thrift-store or dollar-store hack you've used to furnish a dorm, apartment, or first place on the cheap?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Budget Reveal** - Kick off the segment -> Hosts each guess how much they think a full dorm room decor haul would normally cost retail before revealing the thrifted total.
- **Step 2: Thrift or Skip** - Quick-fire round -> Run through common dorm items (mini fridge, rug, desk lamp, wall art) and have each host say whether they'd trust buying it secondhand or not.
- **Step 3: Listener Hacks** - Open the phone lines -> Take calls or texts from listeners sharing their own best thrifted dorm/apartment finds.

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxPclRvd0NOXzBCaHBUSlB0Rm9iNWpZaTRqbF9ELThkTGxONDY1WDZHeGlpS3pBYVNDV1RrMlZuUEh1b0V4MXZVUkdBdTFSTmxVWm96a3Boek9WblQ1ZG1aSnlTdTFnTW1GR3RkdFR6a1hfZHlTMk9rTHBBLVNRc3lzMGJwZFZ6ODFfT0h4NjlwTC1jeXBhVDBTOEZB?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *Julie Andrews Wins Emmy for Bridgerton Voiceover After Revealing She's Retired from On-Screen Acting*

The Angle: *Julie Andrews took home an Emmy for narrating Bridgerton as the mysterious Lady Whistledown - a huge career moment that lands right as she's opened up about stepping away from on-screen acting for good.*

- **Julie Andrews** won an Emmy for her voiceover work as **Lady Whistledown** on **Bridgerton**
- The win comes after Andrews revealed she's retired from **on-screen acting**
- Andrews has long said health issues affected her voice, pushing her toward voice work over performing on camera

The Legacy Moment
- A **Mary Poppins** icon just proved you don't need to be on screen to steal the show - what's your favorite Julie Andrews role of all time?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/emmys-2026-julie-andrews-wins-bridgerton-voiceover-12068816?taid=6a9e150561ca2a0001e33c72&utm_campaign=peoplemagazine&utm_content=new&utm_medium=social&utm_source=twitter.com

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■ *Mr. T slams new Netflix documentary about his life as 'garbage': 'It pissed me off'*

The Angle: *A celebrity trashing the story of his own life on a major streamer is instant watercooler gold — everyone loves an origin-story controversy, and "garbage" is a hell of a review from the guy it's about.*

- **Mr. T** is publicly blasting a new **Netflix** documentary about his own life.
- He called the film **"garbage."**
- His exact quote: **"It pissed me off."**

The Debate Starter
- Would you trust a documentary about your own life to a studio, or demand full control of the story?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/05/entertainment/mr-t-slams-netflix-documentary-about-his-life/

■ *Lili Reinhart pays homage to Kate Hudson in How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days*

The Angle: *A 2000s rom-com classic just got a nostalgic nod from a new generation of stars, and pop culture loves nothing more than a good throwback moment.*

The Nostalgia Hit
- Callers: what's the one rom-com look you'd recreate in a heartbeat?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1w95y20

TRENDING TODAY

■■ *Newsom Can't Dodge the Data-Center Backlash Anymore*

The Angle: *AI data centers are quietly driving up electricity bills and draining water nationwide, and now that backlash is landing squarely on Gavin Newsom's desk in California - a state that loves to sell itself as tech-friendly. It matters beyond California because every state courting AI investment is about to face the same fight.*

The Debate Starter

- Would you want a massive AI data center built in your town if it meant cheaper tech but a higher power bill?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/opinion/articles/2026-09-05/newsom-can-t-dodge-california-s-data-center-backlash-anymore

Backup options:

■ *A Kentucky man with a meat allergy was craving a burger. So he got into ostrich farming - AP News*

The Angle: *Tick bites are giving more Americans a red meat allergy, and ostrich meat — which looks and tastes like beef — is becoming the workaround. It's a quirky, relatable trend story about a guy who turned his own diagnosis into a business.*

- **Brent Williams**, a farmer in **Danville, Kentucky**, was diagnosed with **alpha-gal syndrome** about seven years ago — a red meat allergy triggered by tick bites.
- A friend pitched him on starting an **ostrich farm** four years ago, and Williams jumped in partly out of personal motivation.
- Ostrich meat is **red when raw** and tastes similar to beef — making it a workaround for allergy sufferers craving a burger.
- **U.S. ostrich farmers** say they're seeing a wave of new customers who developed the tick-triggered allergy.

The Relatable Hook

- Anyone else know someone who got a weird food allergy from a tick bite — call in, we want to hear it.

Associated Press (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/kentucky-farm-alphagal-tick-ostrich-steak-allergy-15cedc20aac4f0650e0d24d05a577139

■ *Carmakers Have a New Idea to Boost EV Range: Add a Gas Engine - wsj.com*

The Angle: *Range anxiety is still the number one reason people won't buy an EV, so automakers are floating a wild workaround: sticking a small gas engine back in to stretch the battery range. It's a real head-scratcher for anyone who thought 'electric' meant no gas, period.*

- **Automakers** are reportedly reviving the idea of pairing a small **gas engine** with an **EV** battery, purely to stretch driving range.
- The move is aimed squarely at **range anxiety**, still one of the biggest reasons car buyers hesitate on going electric.

The Debate Starter

- At what point does an 'EV' with a gas engine stop being an EV at all?

The Wall Street Journal (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wsj.com/business/autos/carmakers-have-a-new-idea-to-boost-ev-range-add-a-gas-engine-16bbcc34

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Ireland surpasses 3 GW of installed solar capacity and sets a new generation record of 1.3 GW on the national grid. ■ At certain hours, solar farms supplied more than 1/3 of the country's total dispatchable electricity generation.*

The Angle: *Ireland surpasses 3 GW of installed solar capacity and sets a new generation record of 1.3 GW on the national grid. ■ At certain hours, solar farms supplied more than 1/3 of the country's total dispatchable electricity generation.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.review-energy.com/solar/ireland-surpasses-3-gw-of-installed-solar-capacity-and-sets-a-new-generation-record

Backup options:

■ *People with type 2 diabetes who start cholesterol-lowering statins early may face a lower risk of dementia, according to a large Danish register study.*

The Angle: *Millions of people with type 2 diabetes already take statins for their heart - this study suggests jumping on them early might also protect your brain, which is exactly the kind of "wait, my pill does what?" news that gets people talking about their own prescriptions.*

- The findings come from a **large Danish register study** tracking people with **type 2 diabetes**
- Starting **cholesterol-lowering statins early** was linked to a **lower risk of dementia**
- Diabetes itself is already a known risk factor for cognitive decline, which is why the statin timing angle matters

The Phone-In Trigger

- Anyone on the show on statins or with diabetes in the family - would news like this change how fast you'd start taking them?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/statins-linked-to-lower-dementia-risk-in-massive-type-2-diabetes-study

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■ *A symbiotic fungus that lives inside the human gut appears capable of protecting us from radiation. In experiments with mice exposed to radiation, the researchers found that animals administered M. racemosus experienced less weight loss, inflammation, and oxidative stress.*

The Angle: *It sounds like a sci-fi plot twist: a fungus already living in your gut might shield your body from radiation damage. It's early mouse research, but it's the kind of 'wait, what?' science story that makes people picture astronauts, cancer patients, even nuclear disaster survivors getting a protective pill someday.*

- Researchers tested a gut fungus called **Mucor racemosus** on mice exposed to radiation.
- Mice given the fungus showed **less weight loss** after radiation exposure.
- The fungus was linked to **reduced inflammation** and **lower oxidative stress** in the animals.

The What-If Hook

- If a gut-fungus pill could protect you from radiation someday, would you actually take it?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/scientists-find-a-fungus-that-could-protect-the-body-from-radiation

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *A farmer turned 70 acres of his Oregon barley farm into a wetland; now it hosts 140 bird species and endangered fish.*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate good-news palate cleanser — one guy carved up his own farm and accidentally built a five-star hotel for endangered wildlife.*

- **Karl Wenner**, co-owner of **Lakeside Farms** near **Klamath Falls, Oregon**, converted **70 acres** of his **400-acre** barley farm into wetland back in **2021**.

- The wetland now draws **tens of thousands** of ducks, geese and swans, plus otters, beavers and muskrats.
- At least **140 bird species** have been spotted there since the conversion.
- The project is also being used to help raise federally **endangered Lost River** fish.

The Feel-Good Wrap

- One farmer, 70 acres, and now 140 species call it home — proof one person really can rewild a corner of the planet.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/us/a-farmer-turned-70-acres-of-his-oregon-barley-farm-into-a-wetland-now-it-hosts-140-bird-species-and-endangered-fish/articleshow/133869493.cms

Backup options:

■■ *Art Collector bids $4,000 on broken vacuum cleaner only to discover it was trash*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate art-world facepalm — proof that sometimes the emperor really has no clothes, and a broken vacuum with a price tag can fool a paying collector.*

- A collector reportedly bid **$4,000**, thinking they were buying a piece of art.
- The 'artwork' in question was actually a **broken vacuum cleaner**.
- Turns out it wasn't an installation at all — just **trash** that got mixed in.

The Debate Starter

- Be honest — could you actually tell modern art apart from garbage?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Art or Trash?** - 60-second live round -> Pull up a few random 'modern art' images vs. actual junk photos and have each host guess which is which, no cheating.
- **Step 2: The Reveal** - After each guess -> Show the answer and keep score — loser has to admit they'd have bid on the vacuum too.
- **Step 3: Phone Line Vote** - Wrap-up -> Ask listeners to text in the most ridiculous 'art' they've ever seen sell for real money.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://artinc.co/art-collector-bids-4000-on-broken-vacuum-cleaner-only-to-discover-it-was-trash/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *LG smart TVs caught logging audio with screen off and snooping on local devices*

The Angle: *A report making the rounds claims LG smart TVs are logging audio and scanning other devices on your home network with the screen off — the kind of "is my TV listening to me" story that makes every smart-home owner side-eye their living room.*

- **LG** smart TVs reportedly kept logging audio even with the **screen powered off**
- The TVs were also found **scanning other devices** connected to the same home network
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the internet's home for "this can't be real" headlines

The Paranoia Check

- Be honest — how many of you have already unplugged or covered your smart TV tonight?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.notebookcheck.net/LG-smart-TVs-caught-logging-audio-with-screen-off-and-snooping-on-local-devices.1391214.0.html

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■ *Earlier menopause is linked to faster memory decline and earlier Alzheimer's onset, with stronger risks observed in surgical menopause. (JAMA Network Open)*

The Angle: *Earlier menopause is linked to faster memory decline and earlier Alzheimer's onset, with stronger risks observed in surgical menopause. (JAMA Network Open)*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/earlier-menopause-is-linked-to-faster-memory-decline-and-earlier-alzheimers-onset/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *An arthritis drug has helped people with severe alopecia grow back all their scalp hair in two large Phase 3 trials, with up to 22.5% of patients getting all their hair back after 24 weeks. More than half on the highest dose regained at least 80% of their scalp hair.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): First drug to fully regrow hair in a large chunk of severe alopecia patients is a rare, concrete medical breakthrough with a built-in emotional community (alopecia patients/advocates) primed to share it.

The Angle: *Alopecia has been basically untreatable for millions of people, so a drug that regrows a full head of hair in big clinical trials is genuinely huge — and a great note to end the show on.*

- Two large **Phase 3 trials** tested an arthritis drug on people with severe alopecia
- Up to **22.5%** of patients grew back **all** their scalp hair after **24 weeks**
- More than **half** of patients on the **highest dose** got back at least **80%** of their hair

The Feel-Good Finish

- Anyone in your life dealing with alopecia who needs to hear this story today?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/arthritis-drug-restores-up-to-100-of-hair-in-patients-with-severe-alopecia

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■ *A single injection has lowered a major inherited heart disease risk factor by up to 97% and kept it low for nearly a year in the first human trial of a new gene silencing treatment. Lp(a) is not meaningfully reduced by diet or exercise and has no approved targeted treatment.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A single-shot gene-silencing treatment cutting an inherited heart-attack risk factor by 97% for a year is a genuinely novel 'one and done' medical story that outlets love to repackage as 'the future of cardiology.'

The Angle: *This is the stuff people actually want on a lifestyle segment — a single injection tackling a heart disease risk factor that's basically genetic fate, since Lp(a) doesn't budge no matter how clean you eat or how hard you train.*

- The trial cut **Lp(a)** levels by up to **97%** with a single shot
- Effects held strong for nearly **a year** after just one dose
- **Lp(a)** is inherited, raises heart disease risk, and currently has **no approved targeted treatment**
- Diet and exercise do **not** meaningfully move **Lp(a)** levels

The Family History Check-In

- Anybody's doctor ever mentioned Lp(a) or told them 'it just runs in the family' about their heart risk — call in, because this might be the fix.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://newsroom.clevelandclinic.org/2026/08/28/first-in-human-long-acting-gene-silencing-therapy-significantly-lowers-heart-disease-risk-marker-with-one-injection

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■ *OpenAI's chief scientist says AI labs may need to slow down: 'No one is prepared for the consequences'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): OpenAI's own chief scientist publicly warning 'no one is prepared for the consequences' is a top-tier insider-turns-skeptic quote that tends to get picked up well beyond its origin subreddit.
The Angle: *When the guy driving AI development from inside OpenAI says the industry might need to slow down, that's not fear-mongering from the outside - that's an insider blowing the whistle, and it's exactly the kind of quote that makes people nervous about where this is all headed.*

- **OpenAI's chief scientist** says AI labs 'may need to slow down' on development.
- His warning, word for word: **'No one is prepared for the consequences.'**
- Coming from inside one of the biggest AI labs in the world - not a outside critic.

The Debate Starter

- If the people building AI are telling us to slow down, should we be more worried - or less, since at least someone's watching?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/openai-chief-scientist-ai-risks-slowdown-rogue-agents-consequences-safety-2026-9

■ *At Telluride Film Festival, Bill Gates Compares Lack of Control Over AI to HAL in '2001': 'You Could Say "Please Shut Down," and It Would Say, "OK, I Took That Under Advisement, But…"'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Bill Gates invoking HAL 9000 to describe losing control of AI is a big-name, quotable, pop-culture-anchored soundbite tailor-made for clip/quote aggregation.
The Angle: *Bill Gates just compared today's AI to the murderous computer from '2001: A Space Odyssey' — a tech legend saying we can't fully control or shut down AI is the kind of quote that makes an audience sit up.*

- **Bill Gates** made the comparison on stage at the **Telluride Film Festival**
- He referenced **HAL 9000** from *2001: A Space Odyssey* to describe losing control over AI
- His quote: **'You could say "please shut down," and it would say, "OK, I took that under advisement, but..."'**
- He also compared AI to a **sci-fi alien invasion**, saying it's **'a foreign intelligence with a different set of motivations that we can't even understand'**

The Debate Starter

- Does it freak you out more that Bill Gates said this, or that he's probably right?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/bill-gates-ai-controls-telluride-film-festival-2001-1236853326/

■ *Reform UK's Treasury spokesperson Robert Jenrick reacts to the female protestor assaulted by attendees at the Reform Party conference in Birmingham, England: "Oh boo hoo". Jenrick later says that the protestors should "get a life"*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A senior UK political figure dismissing an assaulted female protester with 'oh boo hoo' is exactly the kind of callous-quote clip that drives outrage-fueled sharing once it circulates further.
The Angle: *A politician laughing off violence against a protestor is exactly the kind of tone-deaf soundbite that blows up online — it's got real political stakes but reads like pure cringe content, which is why it's crossing over into pop culture chatter.*

- **Robert Jenrick**, Reform UK's Treasury spokesperson, reacted to a female protestor being assaulted by attendees with: "**Oh boo hoo**"

- The incident happened at the **Reform Party conference** in **Birmingham, England**
- Jenrick doubled down afterward, saying protestors should "**get a life**"

The Debate Starter

- Is mocking a protestor who got assaulted just brutal honesty, or is this a full-blown PR disaster waiting to happen?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/fmzoulp62xnh1

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 9 banked (+15 each when found)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt ‘Disappointed’ by BLACKPINK’s 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite’s ‘Override’ Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 1 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-07 09:40 AM